



Gauri Rai (above), a Class 12 student of Manav Rachna International School, Gurugram, has won a gold medal at the Khelo India Winter Games 2026, strengthening her credentials as one of India's most promising figure skaters. She won a silver medal at the Dubai Ice Skating Championship in 2022 and has represented India at the SEA Open Figure Skating Championship in Singapore and the Asian Open Figure Skating Trophy in Bangkok. Her advanced training includes a professional diploma course in Sofia, Bulgaria, with the Figure Skating Denkova–Staviski Club, where she earned an A+ grade, along with participation in ISU development programmes in South Korea and the Philippines.

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Priyadharshini E, a Class 6 student of RJ Matriculation Higher Secondary School, Vilankurichi, Coimbatore, is a karate athlete with notable achievements at the state and national levels. She won a state medal at the 2022 State Karate Championship, secured a gold medal at the SGFI State-level competition, and went on to claim a silver medal at the 2025 SGFI National Championship.



Mumbai's harbour is rarely calm, but on one afternoon it became the stage for something extraordinary.

Kiuchenghan Phukon, a seven-year-old girl from Green School International, Guwahati, Assam, stepped into the choppy waters at Elephanta Jetty and set out towards the Gateway of India, taking on one of the country's toughest open-sea swimming routes.

Dwarfed by ferries and fishing boats, she swam the Elephanta-to-Gateway stretch for more than three hours, facing shifting tides and unpredictable currents, before emerging at the iconic monument after a gruelling swim of 13 km.

The feat makes her the youngest person ever to conquer this route and the first athlete from a north-eastern state to do so.

The attempt was officially monitored by observer Rahul Chiplunkar of the Open Water Amateur Aquatics Federation (OWAAF), ensuring strict compliance with international safety and documentation standards. OWAAF founder Pavitra Poilkar was also present at the event.

